

BENZOPHENONE-4

_____Name

_____Date

also called... **Sulisobenzene** or **2-hydroxy-4-methoxy-benzophenone-5-sulfonic acid**. One of its trade names is **Uvinyl MS-40**.

What is it?

Benzophenone-4 is an ultraviolet absorber used for sun protection. It is widely incorporated into make-ups, sunscreens, lip balms, hair products, plastics, and textiles. It is also used in some perfumes for its rose-like scent.

Where might it be found?

Liquid hand soap
Hand sanitizer
Facial cleanser, mask
Exfoliating gel, cream
Around eye cream
Makeup remover, cleanser
Toner, astringent
Shower gel, body wash
Bar soap
Bubble bath
Bath oil, salts, bath soak
Perfume
Body powder
Shampoo
Hair conditioner
Hair gel, mousse, spray
Shaving cream, gel
After-shave
Nail polish
Cuticle remover
Lipstick, lip balm, lip gloss
Sunscreen, sunblock
Sunburn remedy
Anti-itch cream, gel
Hemorrhoid treatment

Potential cross-reactions:

Some individuals sensitive to **benzophenone-4** will also react to **oxybenzone**, also called **benzophenone-3**. Certain people develop their allergic reaction to benzophenone-4 *only* on exposure to sunlight.

Some industrial uses:

Color preserver in paints and varnishes
Color retainer in fluorescent lacquers
Protection against fading in textiles and plastics
Color preserver in dental composite fillings
Starting product for manufacture of drugs, dyes
Starting material for manufacture of pesticides
Component of clear protective window shades
UV protectant in polystyrene, acrylic, and rubber

How to avoid it:

To avoid benzophenone-4 check the complete ingredient list of each product you use for one of the names highlighted above. For products already at home that do not list ingredients, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

You may be exposed to benzophenone-4 through contact with a partner who uses products that contain it. Ask your hairdresser, masseuse, barber, aesthetician, and caretakers to avoid using products with benzophenone-4 in your care.

To identify possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of every product encountered. It may be necessary to contact the manufacturer to learn if this sunscreen is present in a commercial product. If you cannot eliminate contact, wear protective heavy rubber or vinyl gloves.